



The Box.net interface is clean and simple

.Mac is the only service in this review that supports site hosting



The .Mac interface

chronise Safari bookmarks and other system settings with .Mac and other machines), public and private sharing, backup tools such as Backup 3 (Mac OS only), integration with iLife applications, an e-mail service, third-party application support, a free VersionTracker subscription, and more.

.Mac is the only service in this review that supports site hosting. A good feature for OS X users is iLife integration: you can update your blog, podcast, photocast and much more with a single click! Photocasting is a term coined for the service that allows people to share photos (using iPhoto- Mac OS X only) with others. For creating a basic Web site, .Mac offers quite a few ready-made templates.

The cost for .Mac comes to \$0.1/MB per month—somewhat expensive, but decent enough when you consider the features it offers. There's a comprehensive set of FAQs at the site, along with a support forum for users who need help with the services. .Mac is one of the best storage services out there, and if Apple considers revising the rates a bit, their offering will get even more attractive.

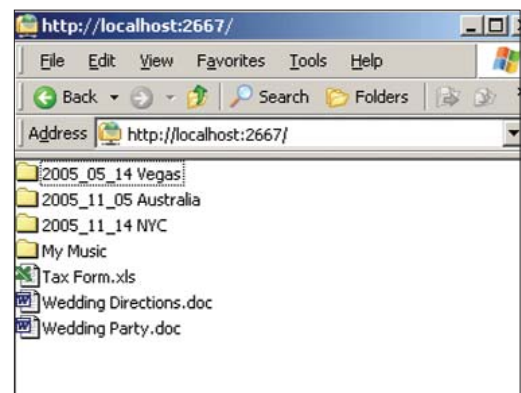
Jungle Disk

Jungle Disk (www.jungledisk.com) is a unique storage service in the sense that it uses Amazon's S3 storage service to store your files

and folders. The pricing model is also different from that of the other services we've reviewed. You'll need to sign up for Amazon's AWS service, which uses the *pay as you use* model—this means you'll pay for *only* the space and bandwidth you use. Dave Wright, Jungle Disk's founder and lead developer, says that Jungle Disk is at an advantage over other services, since Amazon provides the storage. He mentions that since Jungle Disk is based on S3, it is an open system and not closed and proprietary like the other online backup solutions. Since it is open source, you can download the source code and write your own Jungle Disk application!

Jungle Disk offers cross-platform compatibility with Windows, Mac, and Linux. The desktop client they offer integrates with Windows Explorer, and you can copy files to it just like you do to a local hard drive. It is the only service here that does not offer a Web interface—though they're considering putting up one.

Because of its integration with Amazon's S3, Jungle Disk is the most secure online storage solution we've reviewed. You can encrypt your uploaded data using Amazon's AWS (Amazon Web Service) key or your own key. The client will prompt you to enter the key the first time you run the Jungle Disk client. The AWS secret key will be known only to Amazon and to you. However, if you are paranoid, you can provide your own custom key. The advantage of using the AWS secret key is that you can retrieve the key by logging into your account; if you use your own custom key and forget it, you will not be able to access your data.



Access your Jungle Disk like any old folder

You are charged \$0.20 for every GB transferred and \$0.15 per GB per month for storage. Jungle Disk provides a list of FAQs and a support forum. You can also use e-mail for support. Essentially, Jungle Disk stands out because of its pay-as-you-use model and the data encryption.

Openomy

Compared to the other services, Openomy's (www.openomy.com) interface stands out as simple. This is reflected in their registration form and the file manager as well! Currently, they offer 1 GB of space for free. They do plan to increase this. The site mentions that they have plans to offer premium accounts and extra goodies. The official blog (<http://blog.openomy.com>) is where